

Dr. Loren Rush, MA, DMA, FAAR

Loren Rush is a composer, pianist and a digital audio research and development pioneer. He co-founded Stanford University's Center for Computer Research in Music and Acoustics. Currently, Loren Rush is co-founder and director of Good Sound Foundation, a California non-profit corporation dedicated to the advance in the quality of the sound of live performance, and co-founder and director of Good Sound Inc., a California corporation in early stages of start-up created to bring Good Sound Foundation's advances to consumer audio systems and performance venues world-wide.

From New Grove Dictionary of Music and Musicians: (b. Los Angeles, 23 Aug 1935). He studied composition with Robert Erickson (1954-60) and attended San Francisco State University (BA 1957), the University of California, Berkeley (MA 1960) and Stanford University (DMA 1969). He has served as associate music director of KPFA-FM, Berkeley (1957-60), director of the Performers' Choice concerts (San Francisco Bay area) and founding director of the San Francisco Conservatory Artists Ensemble (1967-69, later the New Music Ensemble). His appointments have included teaching positions at the San Francisco Conservatory (composition department chair, 1967-69) and Stanford (1968-69), and the associate directorship of Stanford's Center for Computer Research in Music and Acoustics (CCRMA, 1975-85). Among his honors are the Prix de Paris (1960-62), Rome Prize (1969-71), a Guggenheim Fellowship (1971), and commissions from the Fromm Foundation (1964) and the San Francisco Symphony Orchestra (1973, 1975). His music has been performed by the Boston Symphony, New York Philharmonic, San Francisco Symphony Orchestra, St. Louis Symphony, Brooklyn Philharmonic, Detroit Symphony, Minnesota Orchestra, Rome RAI Orchestra and Pierre Boulez' Ensemble Intercontemporain.

In its delicacy of texture and elegance of construction, Rush's early music resembles the style of other Webern-influenced American and French composers. Many early works are in open form: *Hexahedron* (1962--3) presents the pianist with a choice of routes through its structure; *Nexus 16* (1964) dispenses with measured and synchronized ensemble attacks. An interest in historical precedent is clear in *Dans le sable* (1967-68), which refers to Barbarina's cavatina in the fourth act of Mozart's *Le nozze di Figaro*. In 1970 Rush began to employ amplification to increase the dynamic range of his compositions. Increasingly sophisticated computer programs allowed him to process intonation, attacks, spatial placement and timbral manipulations of pre-recorded material with a new degree of complexity. Later works, such as *Song and Dance* (1975), are dominated by rhythmic organization. Others use digital processing to refine *musique concrete* (*The Digital Domain*, 1983) or to generate pure tuning systems, incorporated as taped sound into music played by conventional forces. He has continued to intensify his study of intonation and acoustics, working closely with the performers for whom his music is intended.

—by Charles Shere, New Grove Dictionary of Music and Musicians